PLUG AND PLAY

PAID MEDIA · WEEKLY REPORT

5–11 Oct 2026

vs 28 Sep – 4 Oct and the 4 weeks 7 Sep – 4 Oct · USD · data to 12 Oct

Leads rose 16% to 124 at $13.17 each, but paid MQLs halved to 6.

Total spend fell 41% to $1,887 because FR_Alibaba ended on 5 Oct; spend aimed at leads was almost flat (−2%).

TOTAL SPEND
$1,887
▼ 41% vs last week
4-week average $4,055

LEADS
124
▲ 16% vs last week
4-week average 160

COST PER LEAD
$13.17
▼ 15% vs last week
4-week average $16.60

PAID MQLS
6
12 last week
12% of all 52 MQLs in HubSpot

BUDGET 2026
$282.5k 94%
Forecast **$303.8k**
Budget $300k · maximum $320k

Arrows: vs last week (green better, wine worse, grey neutral or under 10 leads). Lines: last 8 weeks. Leads = form fills counted by Meta and Google; MQLs = qualified in HubSpot.

By channel

lead generation first, then spend not aimed at leads

Channel	Spend	Leads	Cost per lead	4-wk avg cost per lead	Cost per click	Paid MQLs
Meta	$1,072 ▼ 2%	97 ▲ 9%	$11.06 ▼ 10%	$11.21	$1.35	<5
Google Search	$561 ▼ 1%	27 ▲ 50%	$20.76 ▼ 34%	$75.00	$1.89	<5
Lead generation	**$1,633** ▼ 2%	**124** ▲ 16%	**$13.17** ▼ 15%	**$16.60**	**$1.50**	**6**
NOT AIMED AT LEADS · COUNTS TOWARD THE BUDGET						
YouTube (brand views)	$153 ▼ 27%	-	-	-	-	-
Meta traffic campaigns	$102 ▼ 92%	-	-	-	-	-
Total spend	**$1,887** ▼ 41%	-	-	-	-	-

Google Performance Max: no spend since 10 Sep.

ChatGPT Ads: nothing ran this week. Test 1 (23 Sep – 2 Oct) spent €229.56 for 43 clicks and no conversions.

What worked

- ✓ **Google Search: cheapest conversions since the 13 Aug rebuild.** 27 at $20.76 each, against 13.9 a week at $75.00 over the 4 weeks before. Spend was flat on last week (−1%).
- ✓ **Meta US prospecting recovered.** 38 leads at $13.05 each (last week 29 at $17.75), led by California and US Middle-South. Top ad: the Quantum Computing video.
- ✓ **EMEA prospecting is still the cheapest source.** 26 leads at $5.47 each (4-week average $6.97).

What to fix

- ! **Leads are not turning into MQLs.** 4.8 paid MQLs per 100 leads (11.2 last week). Paid social fell from 9 to <5 while Direct rose from 12 to 21: check the UTM tags on every ad.
- ! **Google and HubSpot don't match.** Google counted 27 conversions; HubSpot shows <5 MQLs from paid search. Google is meant to count only HubSpot qualified leads since mid-September.
- ! **Western Europe prospecting slowed.** 5 leads at $14.45 for a second week, against 14.5 a week at $6.85 before.

Next week

owner · due

1	Meta: test the Quantum video (PP-196) in US & Canada and Western Europe; move retargeting budget from PP-328 to PP-324.	Felipe + Toco	Wed 15 Oct
2	Google: add the off-topic search terms (page 2) as negatives; move budget from North America to EMEA Startup Collaboration.	Felipe + Toco	Thu 16 Oct
3	Ask Sales Ops for SQLs and MQLs by campaign; agree the restated MQL baseline.	Felipe	Wed 15 Oct
4	Check UTM tags on every ad, and what Google's main conversion counts (browser audit).	Felipe	Fri 17 Oct
5	Western Europe prospecting: check frequency and add new ads.	Felipe + Toco	Fri 17 Oct

Decision needed

At $1,861 a week we end the year at about $303.8k: $3.8k over the $300k budget, $16.2k under the $320k maximum. Landing on $300k needs $1,529 a week, $332 less. Trim, or accept $303.8k?

Last week's actions

First report in this format. From next week, this box shows what happened to each action from the week before.

Details: campaigns, lead quality and data notes

Meta
cost per lead with its change against the 4-week average (7 Sep – 4 Oct)

Campaign	Spend	Leads	Cost per lead	Last week	4-wk average	4-wk leads/week	Click rate
Worldwide · retargeting	$290	22	$13.17 ▼ 4%	$12.00	$13.72	28.8	1.17%
US East Coast · prospecting	$179	14	$12.80 ▼ 1%	$15.35	$12.89	19.2	1.70%
EMEA · prospecting	$142	26	$5.47 ▼ 22%	$6.34	$6.97	28.2	1.17%
California · prospecting	$141	11	$12.81 ▼ 11%	$21.27	$14.45	13.8	2.42%
US Middle-South · prospecting	$104	10	$10.40 ▼ 24%	$22.08	$13.76	11	2.25%
Western Europe · prospecting	$72	5	$14.45 ▲ *111%*	$14.03	$6.85	14.5	1.12%
Middle East · prospecting	$72	6	$12.02 ▲ *22%*	$9.03	$9.87	10	1.29%
US & Canada · prospecting	$72	3	$23.98 ▲ *73%*	$14.25	$13.84	7.2	1.69%
META TRAFFIC CAMPAIGNS · NOT AIMED AT LEADS							
FR_Alibaba **ended**	$67	-	-	-	-	-	1.63%
US & Canada · cold traffic	$35	-	-	-	-	-	2.84%

Google Ads
conversions as counted by Google · change against the 4-week average

Campaign	Spend	Clicks	Cost per click	Conversions	Cost per conversion	Last week	4-wk average
EMEA · non-brand Search	$259	129	$2.01	13	$19.91 ▼ *70%*	$29.43	$66.66
North America · non-brand Search	$253	155	$1.63	10	$25.30 ▼ *75%*	$51.55	$100.37
Silicon Valley · coworking (startups)	$49	12	$4.05	4	$12.16 ▼ *35%*	$11.43	$18.59
YOUTUBE (BRAND VIEWS) · NOT AIMED AT LEADS							
YouTube (brand views) · 2 campaigns this week	$153	162	$0.94	-	-	-	-

Ads, ad groups and search terms
from the 13 Oct API report, not in the campaign exports

Ad, ad group or keyword	Where	Spend	Leads	Cost per lead	Note
PP-196 · Quantum Computing video	3 US campaigns	$148	19	$7.78	Top US ad: test it in more markets
PP-324 · “Plan to solve problem”	Retargeting	$88	10	$8.83	Half PP-328's cost: give it more
PP-328 · BizJournals quote	Retargeting	$182	10	$18.23	Move budget to PP-324
Startup Collaboration · EMEA	EMEA Search	$81	7	$11.64	Best ad group
Startup Collaboration · N. America	North America Search	$51	1	$51.30	Move budget to EMEA
Brand ad groups · both regions	Both Search campaigns	$274	10	$27.37	49% of all Search spend

Search terms to add as negatives: web summit 2027 · $12.32 · dubai chamber of digital economy · $11.67 · startup graveyard · startup rip · how to start business without money

Lead quality (HubSpot)
MQLs by original source

MQLs by original source	28 Sep – 4 Oct	5-11 Oct	Disqualified this week
Direct traffic	12	21	8
Organic search	13	20	6
Paid social	9	<5	0
Social media	<5	<5	0
Referrals	<5	<5	<5
Paid search / other	<5	<5	<5
All MQLs	**41**	**52**	**17**
Paid MQLs (sources in bold)	**12**	**6**	
of which Watchleads	11	9	

12%
of all MQLs came from paid (29% last week)

4.8
paid MQLs per 100 platform leads (11.2 last week)

$183
cost per paid MQL over the last 2 weeks (18 paid MQLs)

MQL table supplied by Felipe on 13 Oct. 28 Sep – 4 Oct restated from 38 to 41 MQLs (CRM sync). SQLs not supplied.

Data notes

- Sources: Meta and Google exports (campaign × day, data to 12 Oct 2026), the Other channels list and the HubSpot numbers in the week's inputs. USD; EUR at 1 EUR = 1.1177 USD.
- Leads: Meta = Results of lead campaigns; Google = Conversions of Search and Performance Max.
- 4-week average = 7 Sep – 4 Oct. Budget as in the spend tracker: pace of the last 3 full weeks (21 Sep – 11 Oct) without ended campaigns.
- HubSpot counts of 1–4 show as <5 (GDPR). No ROAS: revenue isn't tracked by ad source.
- Ad, ad-group and search-term rows: 13 Oct API report, not in the exports, so not re-checked.
- FR_Alibaba last spent on 5 Oct and shows as completed in the 13 Oct export.
- Google's conversion goal changed around 14 Sep (agency notes): its 4-week average mixes two definitions.